

FLUID PATTERN IDENTIFICATION

Dr. Yun Xiao
Bastyr University

Review

Definition:

Body fluid is a collective term for all the normal fluids of the body. These are saliva, gastric juice, intestinal juice and the liquids in the joint cavities, as well as tears, nasal mucus, sweat and urine.

Formation and Distribution:

It is mainly related with following organs' functions.

1. The spleen's function of transportation and transformation.
2. The lung's function of regulating water passages.
3. The kidney's function of dominating the water metabolism.

Function:

Body fluid moistens and nourishes various parts of the body.

Classification:

Jin (mobile, clear and thin fluid):

It is distributed on the skin, muscles and orifices such as eyes, ears, mouth and nose, and also fill in the blood. Generally, It has moistening function.

Large intestine dominates "Jin fluid".

Ye (less mobile, thick and heavy):

It is stored in the bone and joints, bowels and viscera, brain and marrow. Generally, it has nourishing function.

Small intestine dominates "Ye fluid".

The relationship of Qi and body fluid:

(1) Qi is the commander of body fluid.

- a. Qi promotes body fluid.
- b. Qi moves body fluid.
- c. Qi controls body fluid.

(2) Body fluid is the mother of Qi.

- a. Body fluid is the carrier of Qi.
- b. Body fluid nourishes Qi.

The relationship of blood and body fluid:

(1) Blood and body fluid are of the same origin.

(2) Sweating and Bleeding.

Body Fluid Deficiency Pattern

Body Fluid Deficiency

Definition:

This refers to there is no enough fluid to moist and nourish organs and tissues in the body.

Etiology:

General speaking, there are two ways to cause fluid deficiency. Fluid production disorders, such as deficiency of spleen and stomach; or some diseases limit water and fluid intake. The other one is profuse losing of fluid, such as febrile illness damaging fluid, diarrhea, vomiting, polyuria, sweating, or bleeding.

Clinical Manifestation:

Dry mouth

Dry pharynx

Dry crack lips

Dry and withered skin without shining

Dry and hard stool, even constipation

Dry Urine (Scanty urination), even oliguria or anuria.

Tongue:

Dry and red tongue

Pulse:

Rapid and thready

Treatment Principle:

Nourishing yin and replenish fluid

Therapeutics:

Herbs:

Scrophularia, Ophiopogon, Raw Rehmannia.

Acupuncture:

Ren 23, Ren 17, Ren 12, Ren 6

Jin Jin, YuYe

Body Fluid Accumulation Pattern

1. Edema Syndrome (Shui Zhong Syndrome)

Definition:

Subcutaneous retention of fluid which leads to puffiness of the head, face, eyelids, limbs, abdomen and even the whole body is called edema.

A. Yang Type of Edema

Etiology:

This type is usually caused by invasion of the wind upon the lung which results in dysfunction of the lung in dispersion; or living in a damp place, wading through water or drenching by rain, and irregular food intake which damages spleen in transportation and transformation.

Clinical Manifestation:

Abrupt onset of edema
Puffy face and eyelids and then anasarca
Lustrous skin
Scanty urine
Aversion to cold
Fever
Achy
Sore throat

Tongue:

Thin white or yellow coating

Pulse:

Floating or slippery and rapid pulse

Treatment principle:

To disperse the lung and remove the retained liquid

Therapeutics:

Herb:

Ephedra, Gypsum, Fresh ginger, Licorice, Chinese date.

Acupuncture:

L 7, LI 4, LI 6, Sp 9, B 39.

B. Yin Type of Edema

Etiology:

This type is usually caused by over strain, internal injury and indulgent sexual activity, leading to weakness of the spleen and kidney.

Clinical Manifestation:

Insidious onset of edema

Especially remarkable below the waist

Pitting edema

Scanty urine

Poor appetite

Loss stool

Distension in chest and abdomen

Fatigue

Soreness and weakness in low back and legs

Cold limbs

Aversion to cold

Tongue:

White moist coating and pale flabby tongue

Pulse:

Deep and weakness pulse

Treatment principle:

To warm yang and remove the retained liquid

Therapeutics:

Herb:

White atractylodes, Poria, Polyporus, Alisma, Cinnamon twig

Plantago seed, Phytolacca root

Acupuncture:

UB 20, UB 23, Ren 9, Ren 4, K 7, St 36.

2. Beverage Syndrome (Yin Syndrome)

This generally refers to various diseases resulting from thin and clear fluid retention between organs, meridians and tissues. It is often caused by hypofunction or impairment of internal organs.

Clinical Manifestation:

Abdominal distension
Prefer warm to cold
Splashing sound in the upper abdomen
Watery vomiting
No thirst or thirst dislike drinking
Dizziness
Anorexia
White and slippery pulse

Pain in the chest or hypochondria
Aggravated by cough and bring up sputum
Even breath and move the upper body
Shortness of breath
White tongue coating
Deep and wiry pulse

Swelling in the limbs
Pain and heavy in the extremities
Fever and aversion to cold
No sweating
White coating
Wiry and tight pulse

Cough, asthma , dyspnea
Foam-like sputum
Fullness in the chest
Inability to lie flat
Repeated recurrences
White and sticky coating
Wiry and tight pulse

Treatment Principle:

Warming the yang and dissolving beverage in the body

Therapeutics:

Herb:
Poria, Cinnamon twig, White atractylodes, licorice

Acupuncture:
St 36, St 40, Sp 9, Sp 6, Ren 9.

3. Phlegm Syndrome (Tan Syndrome)

Definition:

This generally refers to various diseases resulting from thick and turbid fluid retention between organs, meridians and tissues.

Etiology:

It is often caused by invasion of external pathogenic factors, emotional disorders, or impairments of internal organs.

Clinical Manifestation:

Cough and asthma

Bring up viscous and turbid sputum

Distension in abdomen

Poor appetite

Nausea or vomiting out phlegm

Vertigo

Plum feeling in throat

Numbness of limbs

Apoplexy

Nodes and mass

Mental confusion

Depress disorders

Manic disorders

Schizophrenia

Sticky tongue coating

Slippery pulse

Treatment Principle:

To strengthen the spleen and resolve the phlegm

Therapeutics:

Herb:

Pinellia tuber, Citrus peel, Poria, Licorice

Acupuncture:

St 36, St 40, Sp 6, P 7